

■ SOCIAL MEDIA

You don't have to use hashtags on X

We have been using Twitter, now X, for expressing ourselves for a couple of years now and ever since then we have been complimenting our thoughts with hashtags. It has now become a habit. But soon you won't



have to use hashtags on X anymore, and this comes straight from Elon Musk. Replying to a Grok reply mocking hashtags, Musk bluntly said, "Please stop using hashtags. The system doesn't need them

anymore, and they look ugly." This straight up indicates that hashtags won't give us the kind of reach that we expect on X anymore. <https://bit.ly/4fR5VBe>

■ SEARCH ENGINES

Google's search monopoly under fire in Japan

Google, the tech giant known for its dominance in the search engine market, is facing increasing scrutiny



over its business practices worldwide. Japan's Fair Trade Commission (JFTC) is the latest to investigate Google, with reports suggesting that it could soon issue a cease-and-desist order against the

company. The investigation focuses on Google's alleged antitrust violations in the smartphone market.

<https://bit.ly/4284T05>

Apple flags Meta's interoperability requests as threat to user security



Apple has raised concerns over the interoperability requests made by Meta under the European Union's (EU) Digital

Markets Act (DMA). According to Reuters, Meta has submitted 15 requests—more than any other company—seeking access to Apple's software tools for its devices. Apple warned that fulfilling some of these requests could compromise user privacy and security. The EU's DMA, which came into effect last year, requires companies like Apple to allow competitors and app developers to work with their services. <https://bit.ly/4haoMZ5>

Apple to compensate users with \$95mn settlement



Apple has agreed to pay \$95 million to settle a class action lawsuit that accused its voice assistant, Siri, of violating

users' privacy. The proposed settlement, filed in a California federal court, will compensate millions of mobile device owners who claim that Siri recorded their private conversations. The lawsuit centres around complaints from users who said Siri would start recording their conversations without their knowledge. This often happened after the voice assistant was activated unintentionally, and the recordings were allegedly shared with third parties, including advertisers. <https://bit.ly/3PuxLsm>

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